

The Australian Government commenced a review of the FHA program settings in October 2018. The review looked to determine:

- whether the program was reaching farmers in need
- if the original program objectives were being met
- if the program remained fit-for-purpose
- if the program contributed to an enduring approach to income support for farmers in hardship, including drought.

The FHA review final report *Rebuilding the FHA: a better way forward for supporting farmers in financial hardship* and the [Australian Government's response](#) to the report's recommendations are now available.

## Download

If you have difficulty accessing these files, visit [web accessibility](#) for assistance.

The review was conducted by an expert panel in consultation with stakeholders. Panel members included:

- Mrs Michele Lawrence (Chair), member of the Agricultural Industry Advisory Council and dairy farmer, Tasmania
- Ms Georgie Somerset, Deputy Chair of Agforce and cattle farmer, Queensland
- Professor Robert Slonim, Professor of Economics at the University of Sydney and former director of the Australian Government's Behavioural Economics Team, New South Wales.

The panel conducted a [public submission process](#) to ensure all interested stakeholders were given the opportunity to participate.

## Background

FHA provides help for farmers facing hardship, particularly during drought. The allowance commenced on 1 July 2014 and formed part of the Commonwealth's contribution to the 2013 Intergovernmental Agreement on National Drought Program Reform.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/drought/farm-household-allowance/review>